Software Project Management
Assignment-8
TYPE OF QUESTION: MCQ/MSQ

Number of questions: **10** **Total mark: 10 X 1 = 10**

QUESTION 1:

In the context of resource allocation, which one of the followings is true regarding resource schedule?

a. It indicates the planned start and completion dates for each activity
b. It indicates the actual start and completion dates for each activity
c. It shows the dates on which each resource will be required and level of that requirement
d. It shows the planned cumulative expenditure incurred by the use of resources over time
e. It shows the actual expenditure incurred by the use of resources over time
f. It usually shows the weekly or monthly costs over the life of the project

Correct Answer: c. It shows the dates on which each resource will be required and level of that requirement

Detailed Solution:

A resource schedule specifies when each resource (e.g., personnel, equipment, materials) is needed and at what quantity or intensity over the project timeline. It focuses on resource availability and usage, not activity start/end dates (a), actual dates (b), cumulative expenditure (d), actual costs (e), or periodic cost breakdowns (f)—those belong to activity schedules, cost baselines, or financial reports.

QUESTION 2:

Which one of the followings indicates the planned start and completion dates for each activity?

a. Activity schedule
b. Resource schedule
c. Cost schedule
d. Time schedule
e. Program schedule

Correct Answer: a. Activity schedule

Detailed Solution:

An activity schedule (often represented as a Gantt chart or project calendar) shows the planned start and completion dates for each individual activity in the project. A resource schedule shows resource requirements over time, a cost schedule tracks costs, and program schedule refers to a broader set of related projects—none of which focus specifically on activity start/end dates. Thus, (a) is the correct answer.

QUESTION 3:

Which one of the following is not TRUE about resource histograms?

a. A resource histogram is a representation of the distribution of the resources required over the duration of the project
b. The ideal resource histogram should be smooth with an initial build-up and a staged run-down
c. Based on the resource histogram, some activities may be delayed to reduce the maximum demand of a resource
d. A resource histogram is used to estimate activity durations
e. The initial activity network is refined based on the resource histogram

Correct Answer: d. A resource histogram is used to estimate activity durations

Detailed Solution:

A resource histogram displays the distribution of resource requirements over time, helps in resource leveling (smoothing demand), and can lead to refining the activity network. However, it is not used to estimate activity durations—durations are estimated first using effort, productivity, and dependencies. The histogram is derived from the schedule, not used to create it. Thus, (d) is the statement that is NOT true.

QUESTION 4:

There is a need to prioritize the activities of a project, because

a. finding the best allocation of resources is time consuming and difficult.
b. allocating a resource to one activity limits the flexibility for resource allocation and scheduling of other activities.
c. resources can be allocated to competing activities in some rational order.
d. the lower-priority activities can be made to fit around the more critical, already scheduled activities.
e. activity prioritization eliminates the need for resource-constrained scheduling.

Correct Answer: a. finding the best allocation of resources is time consuming and difficult.
b. allocating a resource to one activity limits the flexibility for resource allocation and scheduling of other activities.
c. resources can be allocated to competing activities in some rational order.
d. the lower-priority activities can be made to fit around the more critical, already scheduled activities.

Detailed Solution:

Prioritizing activities is necessary because resource allocation is complex and time-consuming (a), assigning a resource to one task reduces flexibility for others (b), it provides a rational order for competing activities (c), and lower-priority tasks can then be scheduled around critical ones (d). However, prioritization does not eliminate the need for resource-constrained scheduling—it only helps manage it; constraints still exist and must be addressed (e is false).

QUESTION 5:

The expenditures incurred in an organization, which cannot be directly related to individual projects or jobs, are known as

a. Staff cost
b. Overheads
c. Usage charges
d. Service charges
e. Materials cost

Correct Answer: b. Overheads

Detailed Solution:

Overheads are indirect costs that cannot be traced directly to a specific project or job—they support overall operations (e.g., rent, utilities, administrative salaries, insurance). Staff costs, usage charges, service charges, and materials costs are typically direct costs tied to specific activities or projects. Thus, (b) is correct.

QUESTION 6:

Which one of the followings is the proper scheduling sequence?

a. activity plan, resource allocation, risk assessment, cost schedule
b. activity plan, risk assessment, cost schedule, resource allocation
c. activity plan, risk assessment, resource allocation, cost schedule
d. activity plan, cost schedule, risk assessment, resource allocation
e. activity plan, resource allocation, cost schedule, risk assessment

Correct Answer: c. activity plan, risk assessment, resource allocation, cost schedule

Detailed Solution:

The logical sequence begins with the activity plan (defining tasks, durations, and dependencies), followed by risk assessment to identify uncertainties that could affect scheduling or resources. Next, resource allocation assigns people and equipment to activities (often requiring adjustments), and finally, the cost schedule is developed based on the allocated resources and timelines. This order ensures that risks are considered before committing resources, and costs are calculated after resource needs are known.

QUESTION 7:

Which of the followings are examples of oral formal regular reporting method?

a. Weekly progress meetings
b. Monthly progress meetings
c. Through progress reports
d. Through exception reports
e. Social interaction

Correct Answer: a. Weekly progress meetings
b. Monthly progress meetings

Detailed Solution:

Oral formal regular reporting involves spoken, structured, and scheduled communication—weekly and monthly progress meetings fit this category. Progress reports and exception reports are written, not oral, and social interaction is informal, not formal. Thus, only (a) and (b) are correct.

QUESTION 8:

Canteen discussion is an example of which category of reporting method?

a. Oral formal regular
b. Oral formal adhoc
c. Written formal regular
d. Written formal adhoc
e. Oral informal adhoc

Correct Answer: e. Oral informal adhoc

Detailed Solution:

A canteen discussion is spoken (oral), lacks any formal structure or agenda (informal), and happens spontaneously without a fixed schedule (adhoc). Therefore, it falls under oral informal adhoc reporting. It is neither formal, written, nor regular, making all other options incorrect.

QUESTION 9:

In Red/Amber/Green reporting, Green represents which one of the followings?

a. The tasks are ‘on target’
b. The tasks are ‘not on target but recoverable’
c. The tasks are ‘not on target and recoverable only with difficulty’
d. The tasks are ‘not on target and not recoverable’
e. The tasks have been completed but are awaiting formal approval.

Correct Answer: a. The tasks are ‘on target’

Detailed Solution:

In Red/Amber/Green (RAG) status reporting, Green indicates that tasks are progressing as planned and on target. Amber means "not on target but recoverable," while Red means "not on target and recoverable only with difficulty" or "not recoverable." Thus, (a) is the correct answer.

QUESTION 10:

Which one of the followings is the proper sequence of activities in the review process?

a. Planning, Review preparation, Review meeting, Rework and follow up
b. Planning, Review meeting, Review preparation, Rework and follow up
c. Review preparation, Planning, Review meeting, Rework and follow up
d. Review preparation, Review meeting, Planning, Rework and follow up
e. Review meeting, Review preparation, Planning, Rework and follow up

Correct Answer: a. Planning, Review preparation, Review meeting, Rework and follow up

Detailed Solution:

The standard review process follows a logical sequence: Planning (define objectives, select reviewers, schedule), Review preparation (participants examine the work product individually), Review meeting (team discusses findings and identifies defects), and finally Rework and follow up (author fixes issues and moderator verifies corrections). Any other order, such as holding the meeting before preparation or planning, is incorrect. Thus, (a) is the proper sequence.

******THE END******